

Use-Case Flow Specification

Use Case: UC-04 - Approve Milestone

Actors:

Primary Actor: Client Sponsor

Secondary Actors: Content Creator, Payment Gateway (external system)

Preconditions:

1. The Client Sponsor is authenticated and logged into the platform.
2. A milestone exists for the current contract with status "Pending Review," and the Content Creator has submitted a watermarked draft deliverable against it (UC-01, UC-02).
3. Funds for the milestone are already held in escrow (deposited by the Client Sponsor at contract creation).

Postconditions:

Success guarantee: The milestone status is set to "Completed," the escrowed funds for that milestone are transferred to the Content Creator's balance, and both parties are notified.

Minimal guarantee: If approval is not completed, the milestone remains in "Pending Review" and no funds move.

Main Success Scenario:

1. Client Sponsor opens the milestone review screen and selects the submitted watermarked draft deliverable.
2. System displays the draft along with milestone details (description, amount held in escrow, due date).
3. Client Sponsor reviews the draft and selects "Approve."
4. System prompts for confirmation of the approval sign-off.
5. Client Sponsor confirms the sign-off.
6. System validates that the milestone is still in "Pending Review" status and that escrow funds are available.
7. System invokes Release Milestone Payment (UC-05, «include»): it connects to the Payment Gateway and requests transfer of the escrowed milestone amount to the Content Creator's balance.
8. Payment Gateway authorizes and confirms the transfer.
9. System updates the milestone status to "Completed" and logs the transaction with a timestamp.
10. System sends a confirmation notification to both the Content Creator and the Client Sponsor, and issues a payment receipt.
11. Use case ends successfully.

Alternate Flow:

6a. Milestone No Longer Pending / Funds Unavailable

- 6a1.** System detects the milestone is not in “Pending Review” status (e.g., already approved) or that escrow funds are insufficient.
- 6a2.** System displays an error message to the Client Sponsor and cancels the approval action.
- 6a3.** Milestone status remains unchanged; use case ends without payment release.

8a. Payment Gateway Declines Transfer

- 8a1.** System displays a “payment transfer failed” message to the Client Sponsor and logs the failure reason.
- 8a2.** System retries the transfer automatically, up to two attempts.
- 8a3.** If the transfer fails after 2 attempts, the milestone reverts to “Approval Pending Payment”, escrow funds remain held, and both the Client Sponsor and platform support are notified to resolve the issue manually.

Special Requirements

Traceability: This use case realizes FR-002 (approval sign-off), FR-004 (payment release within 60 s), and NFR-002 (encrypted escrow/payment transactions).